



Indian Council for Cultural Relations
(Scholarship Division)

GENERAL GUIDELINES FOR INDIAN MISSIONS/POSTS REGARDING ICCR SCHOLARSHIPS
FOR FOREIGN STUDENTS (AY 2025-26)

1. About the admission

- (i) Indian Universities/Educational Institutes are autonomous and independent bodies and have their own eligibility criteria. It is, therefore, for the students to satisfy themselves about the course chosen and about the Universities. Decision on admission is **solely** that of the respective University/Institute and queries on this thus should not be directed to ICCR. Admission offered by the University/Institute is provisional till the time they satisfy themselves of the authenticity of requisite documents from the students. If on arrival, it is found that the student does not possess the required original documents on the basis/copies of which the admission has been finalized, the students will themselves be responsible for the consequences, including denial of admission by the Universities and student will have to return to his/her country at own cost. ICCR will not bear cost on student's return airfare in such cases. The students while coming to India to join their respective University/Institute should be advised to bring the following documents:
- (a) Original documents relating to their qualifications for verification by the respective college/University.
 - (b) English Translation of the original documents.
 - (c) Certified copy of the syllabus of the last qualifying examination.
 - (d) Valid passport with appropriate visa: Student visa for Undergraduate/Post graduate studies and research visa for Ph.D studies.
 - (e) Award of scholarship letter issued by the concerned Indian Mission/post abroad.
 - (f) Undertaking from the student that the course and the University as conveyed is acceptable and that he/she will not request for change at the time of admission.
 - (g) Undertaking from the student that they have read the terms and conditions/ General Guidelines of ICCR scholarship as specified in the Scholarship Manual 2025-26, available on ICCR website
- (ii) As IITs provide admission in B.Tech Course through a separate procedure, ICCR scholarships are not offered for the same.
- (iii) The admissions in Medical/ Paramedical (Nursing / Physiotherapy / anesthesia etc.) / fashion / law courses / integrated courses such as BALLB (5 Years) / B Sc & M. Sc (5 Years) etc. are not admissible.
- (iv) The students should be provided contact details of ICCR's Zonal Heads as well as International Student Advisor (ISA) of the University/College for their convenience/facilitation.

2. Role of Mission after Admission/Before arrival of students in India

- (i) To automate the entire manual work process of ICCR's scholarship division, ICCR has launched an application, 'Gyan_Setu- connecting Culture through Knowledge'. Since the inception of Gyan Setu app, all the scholarship dues to the Universities/Institutes as well as to the Students, are being released through this app only. The features of Gyan Setu applicable to Missions are elaborated below:
- (a) Missions to login to Gyan_Setu web application, using their respective login credentials provided by ICCR HQ, to submit the details of selected applicants who have accepted offer of Scholarship. The application requirements include the list of students who have chosen a course, been assigned to a University and College (if any) along with the

University Offer Letter, Mission's Scholarship sanction letter and ICCR authorization letter indicating a date of Joining (tentative).

- (b) Travel air tickets are required to be issued by the concerned Mission ONLY and not to be purchased by the student, after checking the tentative dates of commencement of course. Accordingly, the travel itinerary to be finalized and the relevant details including a copy of Air Ticket to be uploaded in the scholarship web application at least 2 weeks before arrival in India, to facilitate Universities/Institutes to make necessary arrangements to receive the students. The travel would only be initiated by the student once the University has accepted those details. The said details will also be visible to the respective ZO/S-ZO/RPO of ICCR in the web application.
- (c) Missions are required to brief the departing students that in order to get their scholarship dues, they should ensure submission of the following details on Gyan Setu App within 15 days of their arrival in India, else payment of their scholarship dues might get delayed.
 - Passport No
 - Joining Report (including joining date and duration of the Course)
 - Bank Account No.
 - e-FRRO registration no.

3. Pre-departure formalities

(i) Booking of tickets by students:-

- (a) The student should request the Indian Mission/Post book the ticket up to (if offered in the scholarship) the airport nearest to the place of university/college where the admission has been confirmed. While booking the ticket, students must ensure that there is sufficient gap between the timings of the connecting flights so that there is enough time to complete the transit formalities, particularly in view of the Covid-19 induced restrictions or regulations. There have been instances when the students have missed their connecting flights due to insufficient layover.
- (b) The student should check the allowed baggage regulations. There may be difference of baggage allowance in domestic and international flights. Students must carry the baggage equivalent to the limit of the lower category (domestic/international). In any case, ICCR will not pay any additional amount on account of excess baggage.
- (c) Immediately on purchase of ticket, Mission should upload their travel details on the A2A portal to enable the relevant ICCR Zonal/Sub Zonal /RP office to make necessary arrangements. Flight details should ideally be conveyed at least 15 days prior to the journey. If airport reception facilitation is not required, students should specifically mention that they do not require any assistance at the airport on arrival.
- (d) Students should go through the Covid Protocol/ requirements at all relevant points in their route such as RT-PCR test/quarantine requirements and follow the same to avoid any complications. Mission should advise the students regarding latest Covid-19 regulations in India applicable to them at the time of their travel. All such expenses on Covid-19 including on related tests will not be borne by ICCR.
- (e) Students should carry yellow fever/other vaccination certificate wherever necessary.

- (ii) Students may be advised to carry with themselves US\$ 700 (at least equivalent to Rs. 50,000/-) to meet immediate expenses. Scholarship expenses will be managed into two parts, which are as follows:-

(A) Hostel Issue:- On arrival, all these expenses are to be managed by the scholar.

- **Hostel fee, Mess Fee, Electricity charges, Caution money and Application fee**
- **Health insurance**
- **FRRO registration late fee**

(B) Stipend/HRA/OCF/Other dues- After completion of procedural formalities, dues can be released by ICCR but it takes minimum two months time to complete the process.

- **Stipend, HRA, ACA and thesis charges (to be paid directly to scholar)**
- **Tuition Fee/OCF (to be paid to University/Institute on receipt of demand)**
- **Air-tickets (as per admissibility)**

- (iii) On arrival, students should contact the respective Zonal/Sub Zonal Office of ICCR and get registered with them. Students must also get themselves registered with Foreign Regional Registration Office (FRRO) within a period of 14 days of their arrival in India. This is in addition to contacting the University/Institute being joined. As a good practice, the students should also inform their respective Embassy/diplomatic representative in India about their stay in India on arrival.
- (iv) Each visiting student has to procure a medical insurance policy valid in India for a value of Rs. Five lakhs or equivalent. As per the latest ICCR guidelines, medical insurance is **compulsory** for the students (at their cost). Students may buy medical insurance in their country before departure. It is up to the students to select the insurance package. During the ICCR scholarship in India, in case of no medical insurance, ICCR is not liable to bear the medical expenses of the scholar. In case of exigencies, the student should contact his/her respective Embassy/diplomatic representative in India.
- (v) Students should carry with them passport size photographs and the joining report form (to be downloaded from A2A portal).
- (vi) After admission, the students are advised to stay in University/college hostel. However, in case they choose to stay in private accommodation, they will have to give an undertaking that they themselves are responsible for their security. If they are staying in University/college hostel, they would have to adhere to hostel policies. Failing to observe hostel rules could lead to disciplinary action by University/college.
- (vii) The students should ensure that regular half-yearly progress report/results of semester exams along with certificate of attendance issued by Head of Department/ ISA of University/Institute and the valid medical insurance policy are submitted to ICCR Zonal/Sub Zonal/RP Office for smooth release of stipend etc.
- (viii) Missions should brief the students that they should keep informed their respective Zonal/Sub Zonal Office/University about their movement within India. If, leaving for their country/abroad, students must ensure that intimation or permission from Zonal/Sub Zonal/RP Office/ University may be obtained. ICCR sponsored students must note that stipend will be deducted for the entire duration if they remain in their home country or abroad for more than a month, although HRA will be paid for maximum period of two months during Ex-India period.
- (ix) In case of any mishappening all expenditure on repatriation of student or otherwise will be borne by the student or the family members or their embassy in India. The student should give an undertaking to this effect, duly countersigned by one of the family members and submit to the Indian Embassy/Consulate.
- (x) Mission is requested to kindly ensure the physical and mental wellness of scholars before recommending them for awarding of scholarships. This has become necessary due to increasing number of cases of severe home sickness/ psychiatric/ other health issues amongst the incoming foreign students. Such students had to be return to their home country, which is neither good in financial aspects nor for the goodwill of both the ICCR and the concerned country. Hence, Mission may take some precautionary measures such as briefing/ counseling of the students, before their final selection/ departure to India

4. Age limit for availing scholarship

Minimum/Maximum Age limit for students under various courses is as under:-

PhD – 50 Years maximum

UG/PG – 18- 40 Years (18 years as on date 01.07.2025)

There is no upper age limit for courses in Hindi/Sanskrit/Indian performing arts such as Kathak, Bharatnatyam etc

The admissions in Medical/ Paramedical (Nursing / Physiotherapy / anesthesia etc.) / fashion / law courses / integrated courses such as BALLB (5 Years) / B Sc & M. Sc (5 Years) etc. are not admissible.

5. Students under AYUSH Scholarship Scheme will continue to be governed by terms and conditions of Ministry of Ayush. **(guidelines as per annexure A,B and C)**

6. No Scholarship for same course

Before issuing Offer Letter to the student, Mission should ensure that student should not be considered for scholarship for the same category of course more than once i.e, in case a student has already availed Scholarship for UG, he/she should not be considered for UG course again. However, such candidate could be considered for award of scholarship for higher course i.e; Post Graduation.

7. Revised guidelines for revival/extension of scholarship

ICCR has discontinued the provision of extension of Scholarship in r/o any student except from Afghanistan who had joined in Academic Year 2021-22 and onwards.

8. Guidelines for Scholarship Schemes (other than Afghan Students) for new students.

In case a new student fails in first year, his/her ICCR Scholarship would be suspended for one - year and he/she would have to self-finance his/her studies. Scholarship may be revived from next year (at the end of 2nd year) provided student clears the first year. In case student fails second time, his/her Scholarship will stand terminated and he/she would have the option to complete his/her course as a self-finance student. In any case, scholarship would not be given for more than the prescribed length of course. Example is given here under:

A student who joined in July 2024 and joins onwards:-

Upon declaration of results:

- a) If a student is promoted to the next class, his/her scholarship will continue.
- b) If student fails, and is not promoted to the next class, his/her scholarship will be suspended and can be revived once he/she clears the 1st year (provided he/she clears the exam at the end of 2nd year).
- c) If the student fails again, the scholarship will stand terminated with no recourse for revival.
- d) Scholarship will stand terminated if student fails in 2nd year/any subsequent year and is not promoted in the next class/stage.
- e) Student whose Scholarship is terminated will not be eligible for return air ticket (if the scheme allows air ticket).
- f) The Council will not extend the scholarship period if student is detained/ barred from appearing in the exam due to shortage of attendance or malpractice.

9. Guidelines for Afghan Scholarship Schemes:-

- (i) In case a new student fails and is not promoted to next class in first year, his/her Scholarship may be extended by one year. If the student fails again, and is not promoted to next class, he/she would need to self-finance his/her studies till he/she clears 1st year. Scholarship may be revived from next year (at the end of 2nd year) provided student clears the first year. In case student fails more than twice, his/her scholarship will stand terminated and he/she would have to complete his/her course as a self-finance student. No extension (i.e. scholarship for additional year) be given after completion of 1st Year. In any case, scholarship would not be given for more than the prescribed length of course (plus one year extension).
- (ii) The Council will not extend the scholarship period if student is detained/barred from appearing in the exam due to shortage of attendance or malpractice.

Guidelines for AYUSH Scholarship Scheme

- a) Applicant should be necessarily of 18 years age at the time of admission in Indian Universities/Institutes. There is no upper age limit.
- b) Applicant has to apply on A2A portal for AYUSH Scholarship Scheme
- c) No application will be accepted after last date of application.
- d) The application will be processed only for the course applied for. No request for the change of course will be entertained later.
- e) The candidate has to fill 05 choices of Universities/Institutes in the application in order of preference.
- f) If no seats are available in the choice of University given by the candidate, the allocation of University will be done by the Ministry of AYUSH in other University as per the availability of seats.
- g) Ministry of AYUSH may decide about the selection criteria from time to time.
- h) The medium of teaching will be English and/ or Hindi.
- i) Equivalence certificate for the foreign candidates is obtained by the Ministry of AYUSH/ICCR from Association of Indian Universities (AIU). There will be no reimbursement of the Equivalence fee paid by the scholars to AIU.
- j) Candidate has to confirm/ deny the offer of admission within 15 days of receiving the offer.
- k) No request for transfer of University will be entertained once the admission is confirmed.
- l) No request for transfer of University in the middle of session or at any stage in the middle of course will be entertained.
- m) It is compulsory for AYUSH scholars to procure medical insurance policy with minimum sum assured for Indian Rupees Five Lakhs per annum.
- n) There is no provision of revival/extension of scholarship.
- o) Economy class Airfare by shortest route will be provided to the scholars once at the time of admission by respective Indian Mission and once after completion of the course by ICCR.
- p) Expenditure on laboratory, chemicals and other related incidental charges will be borne by the scholars.
- q) Any request related to family members such as endorsement of visa, accommodation or any other assistance will not be entertained.
- r) No allowances/fee other than mentioned in the financial norms will be provided/reimbursed.
- s) Any matter not covered above will be referred to Ministry of AYUSH whose decision will be final.

Eligibility Criteria

Undergraduate Courses

- a) **Bachelor of Ayurvedic Medicine and Surgery (BAMS):** 5 ½ year degree course including one year mandatory clinical training (internship)
Eligibility: 12 years of schooling with science subjects (Physics, Chemistry & Biology)
- b) **Bachelor of Siddha Medicine and Surgery (BSMS):** 5 ½ year degree course including one year mandatory clinical training (internship)
Eligibility: 12 years of schooling with science subjects (Physics, Chemistry & Biology)
- c) **Bachelor of Unani Medicine and Surgery (BUMS):** 5 ½ year degree course including one year mandatory clinical training (internship)
Eligibility: 12 years of schooling with science subjects (Physics, Chemistry & Biology)
- d) **Bachelor of Homeopathic Medicine and Surgery (BHMS):** 5 ½ year degree course including one year mandatory clinical training (internship)
Eligibility: 12 years of schooling with science subjects (Physics, Chemistry & Biology)
- e) **B.Sc in Yoga:** 3 year course
Eligibility: 12 years of schooling
- f) **B.A. (Yoga Shastra):** 3 year course
Eligibility: 12 years of schooling

Post Graduate Courses

- a) **M.D. Ayurveda:** 3 year course
Eligibility: BAMS degree recognized by Central Council of Indian Medicine (CCIM)
- b) **MD Siddha:** 3 year course
Eligibility: BSMS degree recognized by Central Council of Indian Medicine (CCIM)
- c) **MD Unani:** 3 year course
Eligibility: BUMS degree recognized by Central Council of Indian Medicine (CCIM)
- d) **MD Homeopathy:** 3 year course
Eligibility: BHMS degree recognized by Central Council of Homeopathy (CCH)
- e) **M.Sc (Yoga) :** 2 year course
Eligibility: Any graduation degree

Ph.D. Courses

- a) **Ph.D in Ayurveda:** 3 year course
Eligibility: MD (Ayurveda) degree recognized by CCIM
- b) **Ph.D in Unani:** 3 year course
Eligibility: MD (Unani) degree recognized by CCIM

Note: Candidates may be instructed to visit the website of the concerned institute/university for details.

Financial Terms and Conditions of AYUSH Scholarship Scheme (BIMSTEC, Non-BIMSTEC, SEAR & Malaysia) under scheme for Promotion of International Cooperation in AYUSH

Courses	Scholarships Rates (In Rupees)
<u>LIVING ALLOWANCE (STIPEND)</u>	
Undergraduate	18,000/- P.M
MD	
• First Year	35,500/- P.M
• Second Year	38,000/- P.M
• Third Year	38,000/- P.M
Ph.D.	
a) First Year	43,500/- P.M
b) Second Year	43,500/- P.M
<u>CONTINGENT GRANT</u>	
Under-graduate & Diploma (Yoga)	4,500/- P.A
Ph.D Course/MD/MS	12,000/- P.A
<u>HOUSE RENT ALLOWANCE</u>	
a) In cities of Delhi, Bangalore, Kolkata, Chennai, Mumbai, Hyderabad & Pune	Not exceeding Rs. 6,500/- p.m. (as per actual)
b) In other cities	Not exceeding Rs. 5,000/- p.m. (as per actual)
Tuition Fee/Other Compulsory Fee	As per actual
<u>THESIS AND DISSERTATION EXPENSES</u>	
For Ph.D. Scholar	10,000/-
For MD/MS and other courses required submission of project	7,000/-
<u>To and From AIRFARE</u>	
For all courses	Economy class Airfare by shortest/ cheapest route will be provided to the scholars once at the time of admission and once after completion of the course for travel from the capital of their country to airport nearest to the Institute in India.
	At the time of Admission air ticket would be provided by the respective Indian Mission.
	After completion of course air ticket would be provided by the ICCR.
